

Peters Glacier

Island of ice

Location South Georgia

Length 3 miles (5 km)

Status Retreating

At least half of the sub-Antarctic island of South Georgia is covered by permanent snow and ice, which flows downhill in about 160 glaciers. More than 100 of these

reach the sea, including the spectacular Peters Glacier with its deep crevasses. Like most of South Georgia's glaciers, it is retreating as a result of climate change.



South Sawyer Glacier

Blue ice

Location Alaska

Length 31 miles (50 km)

Status Retreating

The twin Sawyer Glaciers, North and South, flow off the Coast Mountains of Canada into a deep, narrow fjord on the southeast Alaskan coast called the Tracy Arm. Giant chunks of blue ice break off the glaciers and drift down the fjord, where they are used as floating refuges by harbor seals.



Margerie Glacier

Towering walls

Location Alaska

Length 21 miles (34 km)

Status Stable

Glacier Bay in southeastern Alaska has a total of 16 tidewater glaciers. Named after French geographer Emmanuel de Margerie, the Margerie Glacier is one of the most spectacular, with walls of ice towering 262 ft (80 m) above the water. Unlike most of the neighboring glaciers, it has advanced over recent years, and is now stable.

Ross Ice Shelf

Incredible size

Location Antarctica

Area 188,000 sq miles (487,000 sq km)

Status Stable

Ice flowing off the vast Antarctic ice sheets spills out over the sea as ice shelves. The Ross Ice Shelf is the biggest—a colossal sheet of ice covering part of the Ross Sea and about the size of France. Although it is currently stable, scientists warn that it might collapse within the next century.

▼ WHITE WALL

The floating ice front of the Ross Ice Shelf is more than 373 miles (600 km) long, and up to 164 ft (50 m) high.

